

How to Use Your Escape-the-W2 Planner

SKU STR-001 • ESCAPE THE W2 PLANNER

What this workbook does

Computes the math behind quitting your W-2 to live on STR income. Current household expenses, target portfolio cash flow, replacement-income gap, and the realistic quit date your portfolio earns its way to. No magical thinking — just the income math, the runway math, and the contingency math.

Most "I'm going to quit my job and do Airbnb full-time" decisions are made on vibes. This workbook is the spreadsheet that tells you whether the vibes match the numbers.

First-time setup (15 min)

1. Open tab **Current State** — household monthly expenses (mortgage / rent, utilities, food, insurance, healthcare, transportation, debt service, savings rate). Your current W-2 net pay.
2. Tab **Target State** — what you want monthly STR income to cover (typically 100-110% of current expenses + a comfort buffer).
3. Tab **Portfolio Snapshot** — every property you currently own + projected net cash flow per month per property.
4. Tab **Acquisition Pipeline** (optional) — properties you plan to acquire over the next 36 months, with expected cash flow per acquisition.

Reading the outputs

- **Current Gap:** target monthly income – current portfolio cash flow. The number you need to close.
- **Years to Quit (status quo):** how long at your current acquisition pace to close the gap. Often 4-7 years.
- **Years to Quit (accelerated):** how long if you ramp acquisition to 1 property every 12 months (or whatever cadence you input).
- **Quit Date:** the month when projected portfolio cash flow $\geq$ target income. Comes with a confidence interval based on your stress-test inputs.

What the workbook makes you face

- **Healthcare bridge:** if you're quitting before Medicare age, you need health insurance. Marketplace plans for a family of 4 run \$1,800-\$3,000/month. The workbook adds this to your target.
- **Tax bracket flip:** when STR income replaces W-2 income, your effective tax rate often goes UP (SE tax for active hosts) or stays similar (Schedule E filers). The workbook flags this so you don't quit on gross numbers.
- **Cash buffer:** the workbook insists on 6 months of expenses in liquid savings before quit date. Don't quit and then panic-list properties at low rates because you need cash.

Stress tests

The Stress Test tab models three downside scenarios:

- 20% revenue drop across the portfolio (recession / market softening)
- One property unexpectedly goes vacant for 6 months (regulation, fire, eviction)
- Healthcare costs +50% (catastrophic year for the family)

If your quit date still works under all three, you're in good shape. If any of them push the quit date >24 months later, build more buffer or delay.

Questions?

hello@thestrledger.com — real humans, fast replies.

Upgrade path: The Full version on thestrledger.com adds the acquisition schedule (which markets to buy in, in what order, with cap-rate targets), the partner risk-share modeling (if your spouse keeps W-2 to bridge), and a printable Conversation Doc for the kitchen-table conversation with your partner.